

September

17



1916

Red Baron

German pilot Manfred von Richthofen shot down a British fighter plane over France, winning his first aerial combat. Nicknamed the Red Baron, the flying ace went on to win 80 dog fights during World War I.

Born this day

1960 Kevin Clash, US puppeteer. He provided the voice and actions for the furry red monster Elmo on the US TV show *Sesame Street*.

Swedish victory

1631

At the first Battle of Breitenfeld in Germany, Swedish king and military mastermind Gustavus Adolphus defeated the Holy Roman Emperor and his army. It was the first Protestant win during the Thirty Years' War – a period of religious conflict in Europe.



Also on this day

1683 Dutch scientist Antonie van Leeuwenhoek wrote to the Royal Society in London, UK, describing tiny “animalcules” – later understood to be the first microorganisms ever observed.

1978 The Camp David Accords were signed by the US president, Egyptian president, and Israeli prime minister to bring peace to the Middle East.

1787

New constitution

The US Constitution, detailing the nation's laws and principles, was signed by representatives from 12 states in Philadelphia, USA. This date is now remembered in the USA as Constitution Day.

